COMPANION · RECRUITER SAMPLE QUESTIONS · APPEND AFTER THE MAIN 30-MINUTE PACKET

CapEx Systems Onboarding — answers to the questions the recruiter sent

Who this is for. Rajesh Rishiyur Chandrasekaran, speaking to the Capital Expenditure Systems Lead. Thirty minutes. These fourteen answers sit beside the main packet (cram sheet, 75-second introduction, solution design). Same facts, tighter where the main packet is longer.

How to use a page. The serif box is what to say. Under a story, S / T / A / R is the full version if they stay on it. Every number has a basis: record Apple workbook or resume, record-from-docs a program artifact, user anchor confirm before the exact figure, my division arithmetic, not banked.

Integrity. No inside knowledge of Apple's tools. Public claims are labelled. The resume's aggregate savings line is not used.

1. Tell me about yourself and background.

60 seconds. Built for this interviewer — system of record, data integrity, change without escalation. Same facts as the 75-second version in the main packet; this one leaves out the Flexport customer-scale line and the council date chain so the minute lands on those three habits.

SAY THIS — ABOUT 60 SECONDS

I am a supply-chain program manager. At Sephora I have taken live warehouse and inventory work off side files and onto one system of record. A Utah distribution center moved from two systemic warehouses inside one building to one omni pool, while the warehouse system underneath it was upgraded. Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents, and DC Operations measured processing efficiency up 15 percent — their number. On the inventory book, S/4 HANA and ISM became the one publisher of available-for-sale. The order system reads that number and never computes its own. Go or no-go was a count of rows. The bars I would not move were no SKU with two published AFS values, and Negative AFS clean at T+1.

Three habits are what I would bring. I run data integrity as a program: counted rows, an owner on the field, and an exit bar written before the go or no-go. I move people who have always done it this way without escalating — the person who owns the row reads it before the room does. And I get into the weeds. I have read application logs to find a missing trace id, and I count the rows myself before a go or no-go.

I have not worked in Apple's CapEx system. The job, as I understand it, is to make the inputs trustworthy enough that the system of record replaces the spreadsheet, and to turn one pilot into a playbook the next program can run.

Basis: zero incidents and +15% — record, DC Ops' measurement. S/4 publish-switch and the two exit bars — record design, ISM functional specification. Trace-id work — record-from-docs, Shipment Visibility ingestion note.

2. Explain your day-to-day responsibilities while working on your recent project.

Most recent role on the Apple-tailored resume: Sephora, inventory and warehouse programs (S/4HANA inventory integration, the Utah omni conversion, the portfolio log and the staged cutover). The week below is the Utah dual-inventory program — discovery through hypercare — as the workbook's "How I run a program" and the council record describe it. It is a representative week, not a reconstructed calendar.

SAY THIS — ABOUT 50 SECONDS, THEN STOP FOR THE TABLE IF THEY WANT IT

On that program my week had one heartbeat. I opened the issues log myself, sorted by severity and age, and I did not walk into the weekly review with a number I had not counted. The review was one two-block status: thirty minutes

with IT, thirty with the business, one dashboard, one risk register, no side deck. I said the worst number out loud, with an owner and a date. Steering was DC Operations, IT, and Supply Chain Strategy. Between reviews I sat with the owner of a row — a system owner on a level of effort, DC Operations on what the floor would actually do, Finance on the location re-point, the robotics vendor on the readiness gate. What I counted was open blockers, rows closed, and whether an end-to-end date was still the date. I owned the requirement table, the issues log, and the decision log. I did not own the systems.

A REPRESENTATIVE WEEK — ARTIFACTS, PEOPLE, WHAT WAS COUNTED

CADENCE	WHAT I DID	WHAT I COUNTED
Issue-log review, before the weekly	I read the umbrella program log myself. One grammar: type, severity, operation, owner. Oldest open rows went to the owner before the meeting, not after.	836 rows; 714 closed, 85.4% record. Blocker plus Critical, 441, just over half the book record. Categories include go-live 331, fast-follow 77, enhancement 36 — those are category counts, not a split of 836 record.
Weekly two-block status	Thirty minutes IT, thirty minutes business. One dashboard, one risk register. I said the worst number. Steering: DC Operations, IT, Supply Chain Strategy.	Open blockers, the end-to-end chain (inbound, dotcom, retail), and any date that had moved since last week record, Apple workbook.
RAID and decision log	A slip or a scope fence was written the week it surfaced, with a price, in front of steering. Examples: the functional-design date, and the robotics retail re-slot.	Functional design planned for July 26, signed August 14 record. Retail end-to-end planned January 15, completed at the end of January after a three-week re-slot record.
Owner working sessions	System owners for their own level of effort. DC Operations on floor impact. The SAP and finance track on the location change. Locus on the gate. Blue Yonder on the warehouse-system upgrade. Architecture Council only at its two touchpoints, not every week: May 15 challenge, July 31 sign-off.	44 requirement rows across 23 named systems; seven families, about a dozen domains, about two dozen named systems on the impact table record-from-docs. Last level of effort July 2 record.
Near a gate or in hypercare	Daily blocker count against a written exit. Go or no-go off counted rows: severe issues open at zero, not a percent complete. On the inventory publish, no SKU with two published AFS values, and Negative AFS clean at T+1. The issues log was the triage — go-live, fast-follow, or enhancement.	Issues log 836 rows; go-live category 331, fast-follow 77, enhancement 36 record. Robotics gate 98% pick-accurate throughput, published before a bot took volume record. Hypercare spike: 271 log rows in June, then 65, 21, 14, 4 record-from-docs.

VERIFY — weekday and clock. The record is a weekly two-block status and one risk register. Safe sentence: “I will not invent a meeting name or a clock time; the cadence I can point to is that weekly two-block review, and a daily blocker read once we were in hypercare.” Whether the decision log was a separate file from the risk register is not spelled out as two artifacts. Safe sentence: “One risk register carried the decisions; I will not claim a second system.”

Five-part method behind the week, Apple workbook Part 0: baseline the number, one scorecard, a gate that can stop the work, root cause before spend, the same number proves the fix. About sixty stakeholders on the steering path; the discovery deck listed about eighty names across about fifteen functions record.

3. Why do you want to join Apple?

45 seconds. This team’s purpose: change management, a data foundation, pilot to playbook. No product poetry.

SAY THIS — ABOUT 45 SECONDS

I want this team because the work is the work I already do, on inputs where a wrong field is a real asset. You are moving CapEx off person-dependent spreadsheets onto one system of record, and you have described that data

foundation as what later applications, including AI, will sit on. I have watched a weekly review steer on a number one person could produce and nobody else could check. I will not put a model on top of a field that has not been reconciled.

The day-to-day you wrote down is change management: teams who have always done it this way, and closure without escalation. Those people are not wrong. The workbook was the system. My job is to make the new path easier to trust than the side file, and to close the old path without taking it up the chain. The pattern on your team — a first pilot in the line of business, then a playbook — is how I already run a program. One site, a numeric gate, then the same control on the next program. I want to do that where the fields are a purchase order, a placed-in-service date, and the asset that should match them.

4. What do you know about Apple?

PUBLIC KNOWLEDGE — VERIFY CURRENT FIGURES BEFORE THE CALL

I know Apple from the outside. I do not know the internal CapEx tool, and I will not guess its name.

Operations is not a support function there. The chief executive came up through operations. That shows up in how the company talks about manufacturing: product, process, and the factory move together. Public knowledge. No figure in that sentence.

Manufacturing is largely outsourced to contract manufacturers. Public filings describe Apple as owning a substantial share of the specialized tooling and test equipment that sits at those partners. That is why capital-equipment records across contract manufacturers are a discipline, not a spreadsheet habit: the tool is Apple's, the floor is the partner's, and the record has to survive both. Public knowledge — verify the latest 10-K wording before the call. I will not quote a tooling dollar.

The supplier footprint has been diversifying. China remains central, and India and Vietnam are part of the public story alongside it. I will not quote a country share. Public knowledge — verify current figures before the call if a share comes up.

Every year Apple publishes a supply-chain responsibility report — the Supplier Responsibility / People and Environment in Our Supply Chain report. It is the public window on how suppliers are measured. I have read that it exists and what it is for. I have not memorized a year. Public knowledge — verify the current report title and year before the call.

Reported capital expenditures have been on the order of ten billion dollars a year in recent years. Public knowledge — verify the latest 10-K before the call. I will say "order of ten billion," not a precise year.

New product introduction is the cadence the operations roles sit on. The names I will use — Global Supply Manager, Technical Program Manager, Advanced Manufacturing Engineer, Operations Program Manager — are the names in this requisition and on the interviewer's public profile. They match how Apple's operations roles are described from the outside. I do not have an org chart, and I will not invent one.

What I will not say. No internal tool name, no unpublished split of capital spend, no headcount, no claim that I have seen a playbook. If they want the lifecycle, I point at the model in the main packet and I ask them to correct it. That answer is question 14.

5. Can you walk me through your experience managing program or project management initiatives, particularly within supply chain, manufacturing, or operations?

Story: Sephora, Utah DC dual inventory with the Blue Yonder warehouse-system upgrade. Supply-chain operations, not a slide program. About ninety seconds if they let it run; the serif box is the forty-five-second cut.

SAY THIS FIRST

The program I would walk is a live distribution center. One building was running as two systemic warehouses, Dotcom and Retail, with duplicate receiving and transfers that the customer never saw. We converted it to one omni pool and

upgraded the warehouse system on the same path, with robotics on that path. I owned the program from discovery through two go-lives and hypercare. I owned none of the systems. Purchasing and inbound went first, in January 2025; the inventory flip was the first week of May. Both landed with zero customer-facing incidents. DC Operations measured processing efficiency up 15 percent. The method was a requirement row per change, an owner on every row, and a council that was asked for decisions, not a status.

S — Sephora, 2024. The Utah DC shipped Dotcom from inventory location 801 and Retail from 901, inside one building, with stock kept physically apart. Leadership wanted one omni facility, and the warehouse system underneath it was being upgraded to Blue Yonder on the same path. That upgrade is part of this conversion, not a migration I tell on its own. The Architecture Council was the challenge gate. Two constraints I did not get to negotiate: zero customer-facing incidents, and the October-to-December peak left untouched. record

T — I owned discovery, the functional design, the council case, the staged timeline, the issues log, and the hypercare exit. About sixty stakeholders sat on the steering path; the discovery deck later listed about eighty names across about fifteen functions. record

A — I ran discovery with every impacted team from the March 29 kickoff. Every system owner estimated their own row; the last level of effort landed July 2. The council pack, signed off July 31, asked for separable decisions: the future-state architecture, the location model — one pool, two selling identities, three reserve buckets, no conversion of historical transactions — the staged timeline, and a written fence. Reserve math stayed untouched. Decommission of the old merchandising stack stayed with the global ERP program. Upstream build that discovery had already stabilised opened in June, fenced; the warehouse-conversion, outbound, finance, and reporting tracks stayed closed until August 1. After sign-off the heartbeat was the weekly two-block status. Go or no-go read counted rows on the issues log: Blocker plus Critical open at zero, not a percent complete. record and record-from-docs

R — Two go-lives, zero customer-facing incidents. Processing efficiency +15 percent, DC Operations' measurement. 714 of 836 issues closed, 85.4 percent, with the tail still owned. The approved boundaries held; there was no mid-build argument about what the program was. record

Data-integrity angle. The input that goes wrong in a conversion like this is "which location is the inventory, and which reserve may promise it." I refused a historical conversion, and I kept the reserve model to the three buckets that already worked. Three buckets — Dotcom reserve, Retail reserve, uncommitted — replicated from the Canada logic that already worked. During the four-month interim, one system auto-copied on-hand and on-order from the old location to the new one, and a daily reconciliation watched for drift. The owner of each requirement row owned the input. The control was the row plus the dated end-to-end test that proved it.

Failure / learning. I printed July 26 for the functional-design sign-off and we signed it August 14. I had called a date the owners had not finished re-reading. I do not say the gate chain held to the day. Since then a date on a slide is a plan until the owner signs it.

6. Tell me about a systems onboarding project you managed. How did you ensure accurate data inputs and successful adoption by end users?

Story: Sephora S/4 HANA and ISM — one published available-for-sale. This is the onboarding story: a go/no-go read from counted rows, a publish switch the order system does not recompute, and exit bars written before the night. The Utah issues log is the triage beside those shared go-lives. It is not an ISM-only log, and it is not a second migration.

SAY THIS FIRST

At Sephora two inventory books were each publishing their own available — the legacy merchandising system and S/4 HANA — and every organization meant something different by the word. I owned the signed definition and the one engine that publishes it. I did not configure S/4. The order system reads ISM available-for-sale and never computes its

own. Go or no-go was a recommendation I read from counted rows: the reserve copy equal to the plan, and every old-versus-new difference reason-coded. The bars I would not relax were no SKU with two published AFS values, and Negative AFS clean at T+1. January put the reserve rules live against demand. May was execution. Oversell went from recurring to zero through both go-lives. Adoption was a screen with an owner: Inventory Control, Internal Audit, and Finance on Negative AFS; the ISM application team on the AFS correction report.

S — Two books, three node types, a promise that could not hold. Finance meant the posted book, dotcom meant what it could promise, the distribution center meant what it could pick. Recurring oversell, and a negative available-to-sell that showed up as an order that could not ship. record

T — One signed definition, one publisher, and a go/no-go the forum could read without taking my confidence as evidence. Engineers built the extracts and the screens. I owned the definitions, the keys, the owner map, and the recommendation. record

A — S/4 owns the physical book. ISM takes the lower of that book and the warehouse floor, subtracts what is committed or sold and not yet posted, and publishes available-for-sale per SKU, node, and channel. The publish switch was zero on the old location, then the new one, so no SKU was promisable from two places at once. The reserve-copy invariant: the reserve in ISM equals the reserve in the plan at every nightly cut. I split the cutover. January was planning — reserve rules live against demand. May was execution. The recommendation listed counted rows: severe issues open at zero on the umbrella log, reconciliation clean, rollback rehearsed, control owners named. The forum decided. record on the design and the two go-lives. The 836-row log is the Utah program's log, which those shared go-lives were gated on.

R — Customer-facing oversell incidents, recurring, to zero through both go-lives. Finance closing on the same on-hand Operations reads. No SKU with two published AFS values. Negative AFS clean at T+1. I do not put a cutover dollar on this answer. record

Data-integrity angle. The bad input was the word available, owned by nobody and computed in more than one place. The control is one publisher, a reserve copy that must match the plan, and an AFS correction report with a screen, a role, and an audit row. The Utah issues log — 331 in the go-live category, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement — is how I triaged what could not wait for the next release.

Failure / learning. The adoption miss I will tell is on a different program, and it is the one I got wrong. On an Elementum track-and-trace application, five key users had passed all ten end-to-end scenarios. Two days before sign-off the sponsor opened access more broadly and concurrent logins crashed the system. I reran my scenarios, they passed, and I sent screenshots. I was defending the test plan. I owned the miss. The sign-off date passed. Every critical scenario I write now has numeric entrance and exit criteria for concurrent load at the customer's user count, volume, and network. record

7. How do you identify, investigate, and resolve data discrepancies when working across multiple systems or teams?

Story: Elementum, Austria routing-guide data quality. The mechanism I still use when a number disagrees across systems is the Shipment Visibility rule: events in versus events out at every boundary.

SAY THIS FIRST

I do not start from the explanation already in the room. At a transportation customer, on-time delivery could not be measured. The report said data quality was about 40 percent, and everyone, including my sponsor, believed the carriers were late. The team was spending eight to ten hours a week reconciling promised dates against actuals by hand. I pulled three years of shipment history in SQL myself. True data quality, at the grain we would actually score, was about 55 percent, not 40. The defects were ours: missing rates, lanes at the wrong grain, one carrier under five spellings, brochure transit times sitting where a promise should be. We burned those classes down by reason code. Data quality

reached about 99 percent within a quarter. The carriers never disputed the scorecard, because Finance had signed the method before I claimed a dollar.

S — Austria site. Reported routing-guide data quality about 40 percent. Manual reconciliation eight to ten hours a week. No enforceable on-time standard. The room's cause was "carriers." record

T — An on-time number a carrier could not argue with, and any dollar claimed only on a method Finance co-owned. I owned the analysis and the rules. The data platform team built the engine. record

A — I classified every blank. The rules engine looked up ship-from, ship-to, mode, volume, Incoterm, and the service level. A no-hit paged a person. It never defaulted a carrier. The scorecard could not go out until the automated on-time figure matched a manual sample for that lane cohort. Savings were contracted rate minus paid rate, executed shipments only. Austria went first, inside a month, about 97 percent agreement between the automated figure and the manual sample, about five hundred thousand dollars a year at that site on the signed method. The same rules file then went to the other European locations. record

R — About 55 percent true, against 40 percent reported, to about 99 percent within a quarter. About eight million dollars of validated freight savings across 25 European locations, executed shipments only. I do not quote a two-month or a three-month bar; "within a quarter" is the line both of my own write-ups support. record

Data-integrity angle. The wrong input was the routing guide itself — identity, grain, and a promise that was really a brochure. The owner of each defect class burned it down weekly. The control was a no-hit that stops, plus a pre-release sample, plus a Finance-signed formula. When the discrepancy is between systems rather than inside one file, I use the same idea at the boundary: count events in versus events out at every hop, and give the load a trace id. On Shipment Visibility, data crossed six system layers and a missing trace id was costing two to four hours per blocker just to find the row. That design change is record-from-docs. A note I wrote then claimed about half the time to resolve; I treat that half as my estimate, not a measured result.

Failure / learning. I disproved the brochure times lane by lane, which was slow, and my sponsor was unhappy for weeks. I would start from a benchmark, measure before I blame a partner, and sign the method before the number. The answer to "why is this taking so long" was the defect classes trending down, not a speech.

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8. Can you describe a situation where you had to manage multiple stakeholders who were resistant to adopting a new process or system? How did you drive change?

Story: Sephora, a 20-person Product, Engineering, and QA team, six-week hybrid cadence to four-week. No line authority. The gate was owned by the skeptic. This is the "they have always done it this way" answer, and it closes without escalation.

SAY THIS FIRST

A VP asked me to move a twenty-person team from a six-week cadence to four weeks. QA was a contracting firm. They were heading for a standoff with in-house engineering, and they were right to be afraid: a shorter cadence often means a shorter test window. I had no authority over anyone in the room. I did not write the definition of done and impose it. I asked the most skeptical person, the QA lead, to author it. I coached what a gate has to be able to say — no, on the day of the release, with the room watching — and she wrote the content. In the tracker, a story could not enter QA until its entry criteria were met, and every sprint had a drop date with a reason code, so a heavy story landing in the last two days was a visible re-scope, not a heroics night. We converted in six weeks. Critical defects per release fell by about half. She defended the gate after I stepped back. I did not escalate the standoff. I gave the resistance the artifact.

S — Newly in the role. VP of Supply Chain wanted a four-week agile cadence. QA feared compressed test windows. Engineering wanted the date. Neither reported to me. record

T — Convert the cadence in weeks, not quarters, without the standoff becoming the story, and without a mandate. record

A — One-on-ones with every person. One influencer named per function. The skeptic authored the definition of done; engineering reviewed and did not get a veto. Entry-criteria fields and a QA drop date with reason codes made the rule visible in the tool, so adoption was not a speech. I covered some of the low-impact stories the drop-date rule pushed out, so the team did not pay for my process with a silent miss. record on the mechanism; covering dropped stories is how I kept the window — I will not invent a count of those stories.

R — Six weeks from kickoff to a cadence the team ran without me. Critical defects per release down about 50 percent — that result is on the resume; the workbook chapter is thinner and does not restate the defect figure, so I cite the resume. No direct reports. The gate survived my leaving, which was the test. record

Data-integrity angle. The input people were protecting was “this story is ready for QA.” It had been a conversation. I made it a field: benefit rank, review status, entry criteria met or not. A story with a blank entry could not move. The owner of the field was the skeptic, which is why the control outlived me. A process change that lives only in my slides dies when I leave the meeting.

Failure / learning. I went to engineering first and QA second. The person who can stop the release should be in the room on day one, with her name on the review line. A gate I write myself is decoration the week I am not there.

9. How proficient are you with Excel? Can you walk me through how you've used it for data analysis, reporting, tracking, and reconciliation?

> **Truthful.** The artifacts I can point to are workbooks and Google Sheets, plus SQL where the grain was wrong for a sheet. Tableau and Power BI are not in the resume, the Apple workbook, or the program artifacts I have. Looker views sat on a pipeline the infrastructure team built; I owned the metric definitions, not that dashboard.

> **SAY THIS — THEN THE FOUR USES IF THEY WANT DEPTH**
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> I am proficient at the spreadsheet work this job is actually about: a reconciliation to a written exit bar, a weekly scorecard, an issue log I can age, and a variance table by defect class. I have done that in Google Sheets and in workbook logs, and the mechanics are the same in Excel — pivots, lookups, a counted row against a bar I wrote before the go or no-go. When the sheet is the wrong grain I write SQL. I have not built Tableau or Power BI. I would pick them up on the metric definitions I already know how to freeze. I learn tools quickly; that is how I became useful on systems I had not configured before. I do not confuse “I can analyze the extract” with “I configured the system.”

USE	WHAT I ACTUALLY DID	NUMBER
Reconciliation S/4 go/no-go	Old available-for-sale versus the new publish, by SKU, node, and channel. A difference was a counted row with a reason code, or it was unexplained and the gate stayed shut. The reserve copy had to equal the plan. The order system was not allowed to compute its own number. I will not claim a file named Excel if the extract lived in the reconciliation the team shared; the work was row-level, and I counted it before I recommended go.	Exit bars: no SKU with two published AFS values; Negative AFS clean at T+1. January, reserve rules live against demand; May, execution. record Beside it, the Utah issues log triaged 331 go-live, 77 fast-follow, 36 enhancement. record
Tracking Utah issues log	One workbook, one grammar: type, severity, operation, owner. I aged it myself before the weekly review. The hypercare read was the same log, by month, not a new dashboard.	836 rows; 714 closed, 85.4%. June 271, then 65, 21, 14, 4. Go-live 331, fast-follow 77, enhancement 36, as category counts. record and record-from-docs. The consolidated log in the source set is a workbook.

USE	WHAT I ACTUALLY DID	NUMBER
Reporting Monday review, Flexport	Four systems did not join. I stitched the weekly review in Google Sheets: ticket data plus a manual container pull, matched by hand. Seven frozen metrics. I later specified the pipeline that replaced the sheet. The review format — input to output, a red/green band — is the one I copied from the LSA weekly-review workbook.	1.5 to 2 hours per snapshot. System accuracy 60% to 90%. Parallel run within 1% for consecutive weeks. First automated catch about a 4% ticket-sync drop. The business-requirements document priced the old process at $103,680 a year on its assumptions — priced, not a saving I claim. record and record-from-docs
Analysis Austria routing guide	Three years of shipments in SQL, then a defect census I worked down weekly: missing rates, wrong-grain lanes, five spellings of one carrier, brochure times posing as promises. Until the rules engine existed, the reconciliation of promised date against actual was manual.	Reported about 40%, true about 55%, then about 99% within a quarter. Eight to ten hours a week of hand reconciliation before. record

VERIFY — Tableau / Power BI. Not evidenced in the resume, the Apple workbook, or the program artifacts. Looker is evidenced only as the view layer on the Snowflake pipeline the infrastructure team built. Safe sentence: “I have built the metrics behind weekly reviews in Excel and SQL; Tableau I would pick up quickly — I learn tools fast, which is how I became the go-to on three enterprise systems.” The three I mean, if asked, are the inventory logic on S/4 HANA and ISM, the Blue Yonder upgrade inside the Utah conversion, and Manhattan at peak — programs I led, not modules I configured. A solver workbook I built later for a marketplace design case is a case, not a client result, and I will not offer it as job history.

10. Tell me about a complex project where you had to manage multiple timelines, milestones, dependencies, and competing priorities. How did you ensure everything stayed on track?

Same program as question 5, schedule lens. If they already heard the omni story, do not retell the council. Open with the bridge and go to the chain. If they have not, this answer can stand alone.

SAY THIS FIRST

The Utah conversion had more than one date, on purpose. Purchasing and inbound went live in mid-January. The inventory flip was the first week of May. Between them the floor still had to ship peak, October through December, untouched. Inbound end-to-end was late November, dotcom late December, retail planned for January 15 and finished at the end of January after robotics testing slipped three weeks. About thirty build tracks sat under one log. The business wanted one date. I refused it, because two defect classes in one week is how you get a customer-facing incident. What kept it on track was a written chain, a weekly review that read the chain, and a rule that a slip is re-slotted in the open the week it is real. I did not absorb a miss into weekends and then call the old date “held.”

S — One building, a warehouse-system upgrade, a location-model change, and a robotics rollout, with peak freeze as a hard band and a council that had not signed when the first merchandising tracks opened. record

T — Hold two go-lives — January 15 for purchasing and inbound, May 5 for the combined flip, inventory moved on May 1 under the conversion script — without spending the peak, and without a surprise in the room. record and record-from-docs on the days.

A — I published the chain as the only deadlines that mattered: inbound November 22, dotcom December 20, retail January 15. Every track’s exit was one of those dates, not a percent complete. Upstream location and purchase-order work ran from June 9, fenced to what discovery had stabilised; warehouse conversion, outbound, finance, and reporting waited until August 1. When retail robotics testing slipped three weeks, I took the choice to the weekly steering read that week: compress acceptance testing, or move retail end-to-end to the end of January and keep the test whole. Steering took the re-slot. The dependency list was the requirement table — 44 rows across 23 systems, each with an owner — and the issues log, not a Gantt nobody opened. The inventory publish on those same two

dates followed the S/4 plan: January, reserve rules live against demand; May, execution. Competing asks that lost: a single go-live, a retune of reserve math, and folding an unrelated decommission into this release. record

R — Both staged go-lives landed. Zero customer-facing incidents. The retail date moved in public and the May date did not. Processing efficiency +15 percent is DC Operations' number on the building, not a schedule metric. record

Data-integrity angle. A date is an input. The July 26 functional-design marker on the council slide was a plan; the signature was August 14. I tracked plan versus signed the same way I track a counted row versus a tolerance. The owner of a milestone was the owner of the rows that proved it. A change with no row did not get a date.

Failure / learning. January 15 on the retail robotics track was the vendor's calendar, not the floor's. A readiness row with its own owner would have moved that date in November, not December. I handled the slip in the open. I was late to see it.

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11. Have you worked with external vendors or suppliers during system implementations or onboarding? How did you ensure they followed the required processes and data protocols?

> **Story:** Locus robotics at the Salt Lake City DC, inside the Utah conversion. Vendor statement of work, a readiness gate, the miss handled in the open. Blue Yonder's architects sat on the same program; the vendor I governed with a document was Locus and the wiring vendor under the statement of work.

> **SAY THIS FIRST**
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> Yes. At the Salt Lake City DC we added Locus robots to retail outbound while the building was also changing warehouse systems. Locus brought the bots and the software. A wiring vendor expanded the network under a versioned statement of work: two new closets, thirty-one new access points, a fiber ring, photo evidence before anything powered on. I did not manage the vendor by status meetings. I managed them by a gate I published before a bot took volume: 98 percent pick-accurate throughput, with manual carts as the fallback and the bot-versus-cart split built as a dial. Week two of go-live read 94 percent. I throttled about 30 percent of volume to carts, Locus and our engineers fixed the zone logic, and we were fully automated in week three. The three-week slip in retail testing, earlier, was re-slotted in the open. I did not compress the test to protect a vendor date.

S — Expansion of an existing Locus installation, not a greenfield. Design and build July through December 2024. Physical testing February and March 2025. Combined go-live May 2025. The network scope was written down: statement of work version 1.4, November 19, 2024. record and record-from-docs

T — Land the robotics without adding a customer-facing risk to the conversion, and make the vendor's process checkable by someone who does not work for the vendor. record

A — Five readiness categories on one track page: physical, hardware and network, software, integration, testing. Discovery was three working days with Locus, not an email thread. The statement of work was the physical baseline; acceptance was photos of the rack, the closets, and the access points, and a rule that switches did not power on until the fiber was connected. Interfaces were unit-tested with simulated data before a physical bot rolled. The integration decision on the track was sockets rather than REST, written down, with an owner. Retail end-to-end had been planned for January 15; after the three-week slip it completed at the end of January, and user acceptance stayed full length. The 98 percent gate, 99 percent stretch, was counted weekly. record

R — Full automation in week three. Zero customer-facing incidents through the combined go-live. Locus-side rows were 86 of the program's 836, about a tenth of the book. DC Operations' +15 percent is the building's number, not a robotics-only claim. record

Data-integrity angle. The vendor's map and our induction rules disagreed about which zone owned the work, which is a data protocol failure, not a hardware failure. The network checks had already passed. The control was the published gate plus the dial: at 94 percent the rule fired, I did not improvise, and volume moved to carts until the zone data was fixed. Photo evidence was the acceptance test for the physical data — closet, access point, fiber — so "installed" meant a picture, not a verbal done.

Failure / learning. I carried the vendor's retail date as if it were the floor's date. The slip was handled in the open, which was right, and it was visible later than it should have been. A vendor milestone without its own readiness owner is a wish.

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12. Can you describe your experience working with supply chain or manufacturing systems such as SAP, WMS, MRP, or other database management platforms?

> **Inventory from the record.** One line of what I did, one line of what data I owned. I did not configure these systems. Engineers and the business owners did.

SYSTEM	WHAT I DID IN IT	DATA I OWNED
SAP S/4HANA and ISM	Inventory supply-management integration. I owned the policy and the integration governance for one definition of available-to-sell. The publish-switch plan: the order system reads ISM available-for-sale and never computes. ERP and ISM engineers owned configuration. On the Utah program, SAP was one finance system on the location re-point; I owned the requirement row.	Exit bars: no SKU with two published AFS values; Negative AFS clean at T+1. January go-live, reserve rules live against demand; May go-live, execution. Zero customer-facing oversell incidents on that signed definition. record
Blue Yonder WMS	On the Utah conversion the warehouse system was upgraded to Blue Yonder while the building moved to one omni pool. That upgrade is part of the Utah program, not a migration I tell on its own. The team configured the warehouse system. I owned the requirement row, the gate, and the council pack.	One pool, two selling identities, three reserve buckets. No historical conversion. Go or no-go off counted rows. record
Manhattan OMS / WMS	Peak allocation across the network. I owned the operating rule and the bridge when the scheduler and the floor disagreed, not the product configuration.	3 distribution centers and 100 stores. Fill 99% against a 95% goal. Stockouts down 20%. About $6 million was on the line when the page fired; about $8 million of that day's sales was protected. record
Elementum	Requirements and the analytical pull for a supply-and-demand view, a lane program, the Austria routing guide, and a carrier bid. Planners left a Google Sheet for the supply view.	Forecast accuracy 70% to 85% at the planning grain; about $2 million of safety stock released. Routing-guide quality about 55% true to about 99% within a quarter. Planner collaboration up 50% — not an effort cut. record
Snowflake	I wrote the business requirements and the acceptance gate for four systems into one pipeline. Infrastructure built the path into Snowflake. I did not build it, and I will not say I did.	Seven frozen metrics. System accuracy 60% to 90%. Parity within 1% for consecutive weeks before cutover. record
Locus robotics APIs	Workstream owner. The integration decision on the track was sockets rather than REST, plus tote-type mapping. I did not write the API. Locus and our warehouse engineers did.	The readiness gate and the bot-versus-cart dial. 98% published; week two at 94%; full automation in week three. record

SYSTEM	WHAT I DID IN IT	DATA I OWNED
Flexport's platform	Shipment Visibility rollout and the forwarding application's sequence. I owned graduation criteria, the weekly review, and which workflow went first. Engineering owned the build.	Events in versus events out at each system boundary, and a trace id on the load. Customer counts and cost-to-serve sit in the main packet if they ask; I will not stack them onto this list. record-from-docs on the boundary count.

How I learn a new system. I sit with the person who runs the screen. I take one transaction and walk it backward to the row. I count what entered a boundary and what left it before I trust a dashboard. That is how I learned the S/4 and ISM publish without configuring either system, and how I found a missing trace id by reading application logs across six layers. The gate comes before my confidence does.

> **VERIFY — MRP as a configured module.** Planning grain — forecast, safety stock, a lane promise — is on Elementum and against SAP extracts. Hands-on MRP configuration is not in the record. Safe sentence: "I can tell you what the planning input has to mean, and I can reconcile it. I will not tell you I configured MRP."

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13. Tell me about a time you identified an operational inefficiency or process gap. What steps did you take to improve it, and what was the outcome?

> **Story:** Elementum, the semi-annual carrier bid. The gap was reconciliation dressed up as optimization. user anchor on the cycle time — it is not in the Apple workbook. No award dollar. If they want a document-backed gap with no duration claim, use the Customs ownership note at the bottom.

> **SAY THIS FIRST**
>
> A transportation team ran a carrier bid twice a year and called it an optimization problem. Hundreds of lanes, dozens of rate files, constraints like volume commitments and incumbency floors, about six weeks a cycle. I did not own the award, and Transportation, Procurement, and engineering did not report to me. I sat through one full cycle and logged the hours. The six weeks were not the optimizer. They were reconciling lane names and mode codes that meant different things in every carrier file. I wrote a lane master — one origin, one destination, one mode — and I turned every tribal constraint into one written rule. Before any scenario ran, the rules had to reproduce the last two real awards with under a five percent mismatch, and each scenario had to be explainable in one sentence. We parallel-ran one region. The cycle went to about three weeks, and other regions adopted it without a mandate. I claim no dollar on the award.

S — Semi-annual bid. The room, my sponsor, and engineering all assumed the bottleneck was the solver. Origin, destination, and mode were spelled differently per carrier. user anchor

T — Cut the cycle without touching the award, and without authority over the people who owned the rates. user anchor

A — Hour log on one live cycle, then a lane master and explicit constraint rules. The gate was a back-test against the last two awards, under five percent mismatch, before the optimizer was allowed to run. One region in parallel. I refused to publish a "savings" number on the award. user anchor

R — About six weeks to about three. The pilot region was early; other regions picked it up without a mandate. No award dollar, in the story or in this answer. user anchor

Data-integrity angle. The bad input was identity: the same lane under more than one name, and a constraint that lived in someone's head. The owner of a word in a rule had to be the owner of that field. The control was the back-test — the new rules had to reproduce history inside a written mismatch line — which is the same shape as

a go/no-go read from counted rows. A process gap that is actually a data gap does not get fixed by a faster meeting.

Failure / learning. Procurement joined after design sign-off, and “incumbency floor” meant two different things in the room. Every function that owns a word in a rule is in discovery on day one.

If they want the version with a signed page and no duration. At Flexport, Customs Platform and Freight Forwarding Applications were both building customs-declaration work. I stopped the organization argument and mapped the 2023 roadmap at work-item grain: 15 items, 12 export and 3 import. The agreement was that Freight Forwarding Applications owned all of them except ISF filing. The documented result is decision closure and an explicit interface, not a cycle-time or a dollar. record-from-docs My first framing was “Customs owns customs,” which cannot be configured. The grain that works is the grain where the work changes hands.

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14. How familiar are you with the Apple ecosystem, its internal systems, and the way different teams collaborate across Apple's supply chain and operations?

PUBLIC KNOWLEDGE — VERIFY CURRENT FIGURES BEFORE THE CALL. NO INTERNAL SYSTEM IS NAMED BELOW.

Say this, and then stop for their correction. “I do not have inside knowledge of Apple’s internal systems; here is my model of how the CapEx lifecycle runs across GSM, TPM, AME, CM, Finance and the Systems PM — correct me where I’m wrong.”

What I know from the outside is in question 4, and I will not re-read it unless they ask. The one figure I will repeat if they ask for scale: reported capital expenditures on the order of ten billion dollars a year in recent years. Public knowledge — verify the latest 10-K before the call. Manufacturing largely at contract manufacturers, with Apple owning much of the specialized tooling and test equipment placed at those partners, is why a CapEx record across those partners is a real discipline. Supplier diversification — India and Vietnam alongside China — and the annual Supplier Responsibility report are public. The role names GSM, TPM, AME, and OPM are the names in this requisition and on the interviewer’s public profile. I do not have an org chart.

THE MODEL, IN ONE BREATH — THE PICTURE IS THE SOLUTION-DESIGN SECTION OF THE MAIN PACKET

A program needs capacity. Capacity becomes a list of tools and fixtures. Finance appropriates it. The Global Supply Manager sources it. The supplier builds it. Someone accepts it, ships it, and installs it at the contract manufacturer. Finance capitalizes it: asset identity, placed-in-service date, where it sits, who is custodian. The line ramps. Later the same asset is reused, retrofitted, or disposed of. The Technical Program Manager and the Advanced Manufacturing Engineer own the technical need. The contract manufacturer lives with the tool. Finance owns the book. The Systems PM owns the record. The Data Integrity PM owns whether the input that was typed is the input the next team can trust. The fields I would watch first are the ones that break quietly: purchase order to asset, placed-in-service date, quantity versus serialized units, site, cost center, and which program a shared tool belongs to. That swimlane, the ownership table, and the onboarding runbook are drawn in the solution-design section of the main packet. I will walk them only if you want the picture, and I will mark anything you correct.

Collaboration, said without an internal map. From the outside, these teams meet on a launch: engineering wants a capability, finance has a number, the supply manager has a supplier, the contract manufacturer has a floor, and the system of record is what keeps those four from each keeping a private workbook. I have done that meeting. I have not done it inside Apple. Change without escalation, on this team, means the owner of the field agrees the field before anyone escalates the person.

Answer → story → number

#	QUESTION, SHORT	STORY	NUMBER TO LAND
1	Tell me about yourself	Utah omni pool, then S/4 publish-switch. 60 seconds.	Zero incidents; +15% DC Ops; no SKU with two published AFS values; Negative AFS clean at T+1
2	Day to day, recent project	Utah program week. Two-block status, issues log, counted-row gate.	836 rows, 85.4% closed; 44 rows / 23 systems; 331 / 77 / 36
3	Why Apple	This team: system of record, change without escalation, pilot to playbook.	No new number. Do not quote a tooling dollar.
4	What do you know about Apple	Public only. CEO through operations; CM tooling; India and Vietnam; annual supply-chain report; NPI roles.	Order of ten billion a year — verify the latest 10-K
5	Program management in operations	Utah dual inventory. Discovery, council, two go-lives.	Jul 26 planned, Aug 14 signed; three reserve buckets; +15%; zero incidents
6	Systems onboarding, data, adoption	S/4 HANA and ISM. Counted-row go/no-go. Failure alternate: Elementum UAT.	January reserve rules, May execution; oversell recurring to zero. Five users × ten scenarios; concurrency failed two days before sign-off
7	Discrepancies across systems	Austria routing guide. Events-in versus events-out as the mechanism.	~55% true vs ~40% reported → ~99% within a quarter
8	Stakeholders resistant to a new process	20-person cadence. Gate owned by the skeptic.	6-week to 4-week in 6 weeks; critical defects about −50%
9	Excel	S/4 old-versus-new AFS; issues workbook; Sheets WBR; SQL defect census.	Negative AFS clean at T+1; 836; 60%→90%; 8–10 hrs a week. No Tableau claim.
10	Many timelines, competing priorities	Same Utah program, schedule lens. Do not retell question 5.	Nov 22 / Dec 20 / Jan 15→end of January / May 5; ~30 build tracks
11	External vendors	Locus, Salt Lake City. Statement of work, gate, open slip.	94% vs a 98% gate; ~30% to carts; full automation in week three
12	SAP, WMS, other platforms	S/4 and ISM, Blue Yonder inside Utah, Manhattan, Elementum, Snowflake, Locus, Flexport. One line each above.	One number per system, already in the table. No MRP-configuration claim.
13	Process gap	Carrier bid. Backup: Customs ownership at work-item grain.	~6 weeks → ~3; no award dollar. Backup: 15 work items, 12 export + 3 import
14	Apple ecosystem and how teams collaborate	Honest line, then the lifecycle model. Picture is the main packet's solution-design section.	Same 10-K line as question 4, only if asked. No internal tool name.

VERIFY list — safe sentences

- **Steering clock.** "I will not invent a meeting name or a clock time. The cadence I can point to is a weekly two-block status, thirty minutes IT and thirty business, and a daily blocker read in hypercare."
- **Decision log versus risk register.** "One risk register carried the decisions. I will not claim a second system."
- **Tableau and Power BI.** Not in the sources. "I have built the metrics behind weekly reviews in Excel and SQL; Tableau I would pick up quickly — I learn tools fast, which is how I became the go-to on three enterprise systems."
- **MRP configuration.** "I can tell you what the planning input has to mean, and I can reconcile it. I will not tell you I configured MRP."
- **Carrier-bid cycle.** Not in the Apple workbook. "My program anchor is about six weeks to about three. I claim no award savings."
- **Austria duration.** Workbook and the other canon differ. "Data quality reached about 99 percent within a quarter."

- **Elementum UAT.** “Five key users passed ten scenarios. Concurrent access crashed the system two days before sign-off. I missed the date. Load is now an entrance criterion.”
- **S/4 annual dollar.** “If they ask for money on the inventory definition, about one million of support cost retired is my program anchor, and the rest of the annual figure is my model. I do not open with it, and I do not say a bare total.”
- **Trace-id speedup.** “Two to four hours to locate a blocker is in the ingestion note. ‘About half the time’ is my estimate, not a measured result.”
- **Functional-design date.** “Planned July 26, signed August 14. I do not say the gate chain held to the day.”
- **Resume aggregate.** Do not say it. “I will use each program’s number with its noun.”
- **Marketplace solver workbook.** “A design case I worked, not a client result.”
- **Utah hypercare.** “The counted spike is 271 log rows in June, then 65, 21, 14, 4. A daily bar of under two blockers, sustained, is the bar I would describe as mine. I will not invent the clock time.”

Source trace

Number, then story, then where it lives. “Apple v11” is the candidate’s workbook. “Council deck” is the July 31, 2024 Architecture Council sign-off. “Issues log” is the consolidated Utah log. “Delta” is the Apple numbers-check add-on. Match means the say-aloud line agrees with that source’s safe wording.

NUMBER	STORY	SOURCE	MATCH
Zero customer-facing incidents; +15% processing efficiency	1, 5, 10	Apple v11 C1; resume; delta numbers-check	Y — DC Ops’ measurement
Publish switch: order system reads ISM AFS and never computes. Exit bars: no SKU with two published AFS values; Negative AFS clean at T+1. January reserve rules live against demand; May execution. Oversell recurring → zero.	1, 6, 9, 12	S/4 end-to-end add-on; S1 cutover phase in the panel pack	Y — record design. No cutover dollar in the say-aloud
Five users × ten scenarios; concurrency failed two days before sign-off	6	Apple delta, Elementum track-and-trace UAT	Y. The date was missed
836 rows; 714 closed = 85.4%; Blocker+Critical 441	2, 5, 9	Apple v11 C2; issues log recompute in the numbers canon	Y
Go-live 331 / fast-follow 77 / enhancement 36	2	Apple v11 C2; issues log	Y — category counts, not a split of 836
44 requirement rows; 23 systems; seven families	2, 5	Council deck pp. 9, 13–14	Y. “About a dozen” remains the domain count
Reserve-copy invariant: ISM reserve equals the plan at the nightly cut	6, 9	S/4 reserve-copy invariants	Y — record design
FSD planned Jul 26, signed Aug 14; councils May 15 and Jul 31	2, 5, 10	Council deck p. 10; Apple v11 C4	Y. Never “held to the day”
Jan 15 and May 5; retail E2E to end of January; Nov 22 / Dec 20	5, 10	Council deck p. 10; Apple v11 C1/C3	Y
Three reserve buckets; no historical conversion	5	Council deck p. 4 and requirement rows	Y
~30 build tracks; weekly two-block status; 60+ / ~80 names	2, 10	Apple v11 C1/C2/C4	Y. Not “fifteen tracks”
~55% true vs ~40% reported → ~99% within a quarter; 8–10 hrs/week	7, 9	Apple v11 F2; delta numbers-check	Y — “within a quarter”
Events in vs events out; 2–4 hours per blocker	7, 12	Shipment Visibility 3PL ingestion note	Y. Half-time claim is an estimate
20 people; 6-week → 4-week in 6 weeks; defects about −50%	8	Apple v11 D3; resume for the defect figure	Y

NUMBER	STORY	SOURCE	MATCH
60% → 90%; seven metrics; parity within 1%; ~4% drop; $103,680 priced	9, 12	Apple v11 A3; Zendesk-to-Snowflake BRD	Y — priced, not saved
98% gate; week two 94%; ~30% throttled; full automation week three; 86 of 836	11	Apple v11 C3; Locus SOW v1.4 (Nov 19, 2024); issues log	Y
3 DCs + 100 stores; 99% vs 95%; stockouts −20%; ~$6M on the line; ~$8M protected	12	Apple v11 M1; resume; delta numbers-check	Y — nouns kept apart
Forecast 70% → 85%; about $2M safety stock; collaboration +50%	12	Apple v11 F3; resume	Y. Not an effort cut. Not added to any other dollar
~6 weeks → ~3; under 5% back-test; no award dollar	13	Numbers canon S17; panel process pack. Not in Apple v11	User anchor. No award dollar
15 work items; 12 export + 3 import; all except ISF filing	13	Customs / FFA ownership proposal	Y — decision closure, no outcome dollar
Order of ten billion dollars a year	4, 14	Public company filings, not a candidate record	Labelled. Verify the latest 10-K

Sources: CapEx brief; numbers canon; Apple delta numbers-check and resume map (the resume text file and the addendum were not on disk); Utah council pack; S/4 and ISM end-to-end add-on; Locus statement of work; Elementum process pack (Austria, cadence, carrier bid, UAT failure); Flexport (Customs, Snowflake, trace-id). Main packet files were not edited.